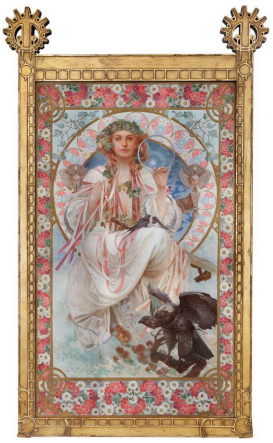
PRAGUE, CZECHIA

National Gallery Prague: Masterpieces

Twenty works from the National Gallery Prague, moving between self-portrait, allegory and inhabited landscape.



In one self-portrait, Henri Rousseau makes himself much larger than the city behind him. In another, Pepa Mařáková places herself beside her father and their painting equipment. Both announce an artist's presence, but they give that presence a different setting: a public landscape in one case, a shared working relationship in the other.

The National Gallery Prague selection moves between such individual identities and figures asked to represent something larger, including Slavia, charity and a regional community. Landscapes also contain human choices, whether in cultivated plots or sharply reorganised colour. The entries follow these changes without proposing that all twenty works belong to one style or one national story.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/national-gallery-prague

The selection · 20

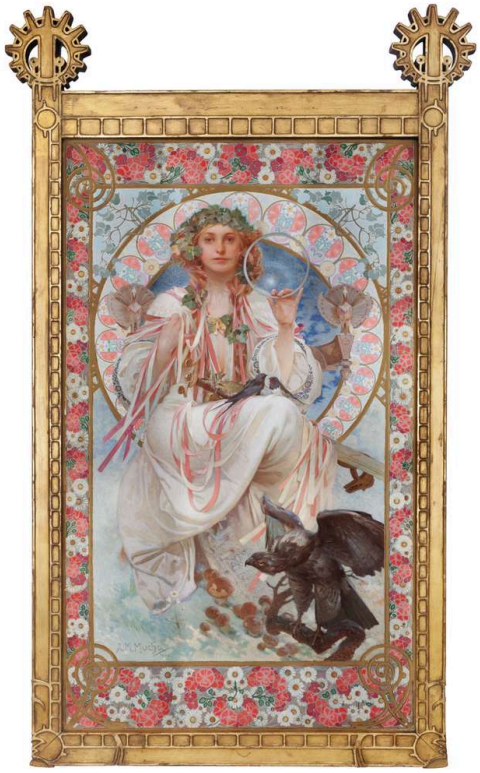
1. Josephine Crane-Bradley as Slavia
   Alphonse Mucha · 1908
2. Czech Heart
   Alphonse Mucha · 1917
3. Self-Portrait from Île Saint-Louis
   Henri Rousseau · 1890
4. Tatyana Repina, the Artist's Mother
   Ilya Repin · 1867
5. The Gardens of l'Hermitage, Pontoise
   Camille Pissarro · 1867
6. Nocturne
   Robert Macaulay Stevenson · 1893
7. A Road on Lopud
   Václav Špála · 1915
8. Eve with an Apple
   Václav Špála · 1911–1912
9. Self-Portrait
   Václav Špála · 1908
10. Three Washerwomen
    Václav Špála · 1913
11. At an Exhibition in Paris
    Karel Špillar · 1906
12. In a Café
    Karel Špillar · 1904
13. Children Receiving Breakfast
    Ferdinand Georg Waldmüller · 1859
14. Count and Countess von Hartig as Roman Charity
    Barbara Krafft · 1797
15. Diogenes
    Maximilian Pirner · 1893
16. Evening Silence
    Antonín Hudeček · 1900
17. Self-Portrait with Her Father
    Pepa Mařáková · 1896
18. Mountain Lake in the Giant Mountains
    Otakar Lebeda · 1896
19. Moravian Slovak Madonna: Moravian Song
    Jožа Uprka · 1902
20. Sunday on the Periphery
    Georges Kars · 1920

01 / 20

Josephine Crane-Bradley as Slavia

Alphonse Mucha

1908 · National Gallery Prague



Alphonse Mucha. Portrait of Josephine Crane-Bradley as Slavia. Image credit: Alphonse Mucha; Source credit: Národní galerie v Praze. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The seated woman remains a particular sitter, but her ceremonial dress and emblematic surroundings ask her to represent Slavia as well. Portrait and personification therefore coexist rather than replacing one another. The patterned frame helps make that transformation public: a named individual is presented within a design whose meaning extends beyond her biography.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 3978

02 / 20

Czech Heart

Alphonse Mucha

1917 · National Gallery Prague



Alphonse Mucha. Czech Heart. Image credit: Alphonse Mucha; Source credit: National Gallery Prague. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Proportional resize and JPEG compression; full source frame retained. · Public domain

The woman's lowered hand and the child's slight body make an unequal relation of care immediately legible. Mucha reduces the allegorical task to a close encounter instead of multiplying decorative signs. The title asks for a larger meaning, but the physical relation between these two figures supplies its clearest foundation.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 3641

03 / 20

Self-Portrait from Île Saint-Louis

Henri Rousseau

1890 · National Gallery Prague



Henri Rousseau. Self Portrait from L'ile Saint Louis. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Palette and brush identify the large dark figure as a painter, while the city behind provides a world in which he claims a place. The museum calls the work *Myself: Portrait–Landscape*, a useful description of its unequal partnership. The surroundings remain recognisable without controlling the scale of the artist standing before them.

Object source · Open artwork

04 / 20

Tatyana Repina, the Artist’s Mother

Ilya Repin

1867 · Oil on canvas · National Gallery Prague



Ilya Repin. Tatyana Repina, the Artist's Mother. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/ilya-repin/tatyana-repina-the-artist-s-mother-1867 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

The shawl encloses the face, and the close crop removes hands and most of the body from consideration. Repin's mother is consequently presented through a limited set of features and fabric. The family relationship supplies context, but it does not authorise a story about her thoughts at the moment represented.

Object source · Open artwork

05 / 20

The Gardens of l’Hermitage, Pontoise

Camille Pissarro

1867 · Oil on canvas · National Gallery Prague



The Gardens of l'Hermitage, Pontoise. WikiArt; Camille Pissarro. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Public domain

The hillside is cultivated rather than untouched. Walls, paths and planted plots divide it before the small workers become distinct, so human activity is visible in the land's structure as well as in its inhabitants. Pissarro gives gardening and settlement a scale that remains legible across a view dominated by trees, houses and sky.

Object source · Open artwork

06 / 20

Nocturne

Robert Macaulay Stevenson

1893 · National Gallery Prague



Robert Macaulay Stevenson. Nocturne. Image credit: Robert Macaulay Stevenson; Source credit: National Gallery in Prague. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Trees and their reflections establish matching dark shapes around the water. A small bright area becomes conspicuous within the restricted tonal range. Since the available reproduction is monochrome, colour cannot safely carry the explanation; the important relations visible here are between silhouettes, light intervals and the darker areas enclosing them.

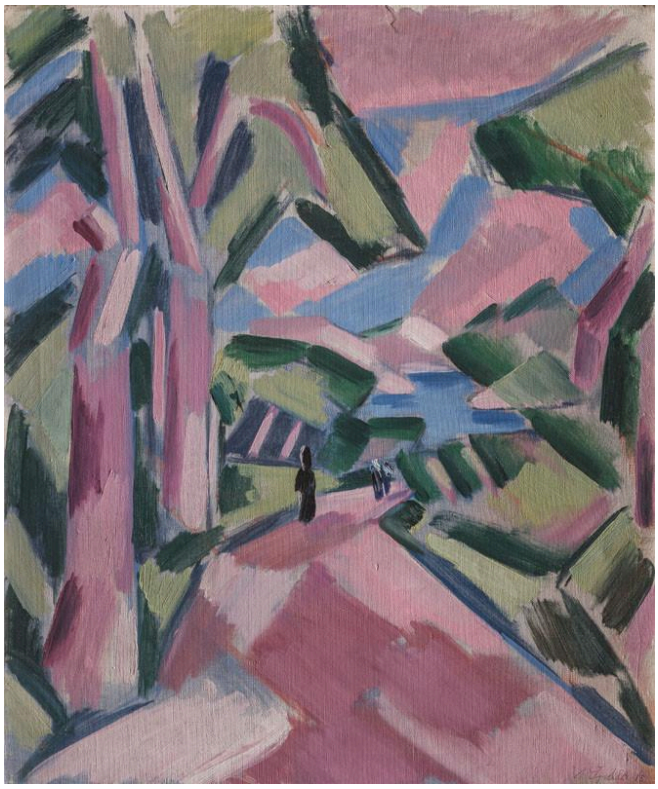
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 716

07 / 20

A Road on Lopud

Václav Špála

1915 · National Gallery Prague



Václav Špála. A Road on Lopud. Image credit: Václav Špála; Source credit: https://sbirky.ngprague.cz/dielo/CZE:NG.O_8598. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The road remains a route through the landscape, but angular trees and planes of pink, blue and green prevent it from opening as one continuous corridor. Špála gives forward movement a series of visual interruptions. Recognisable geography and conspicuous colour construction coexist, neither entirely subordinated to the other.

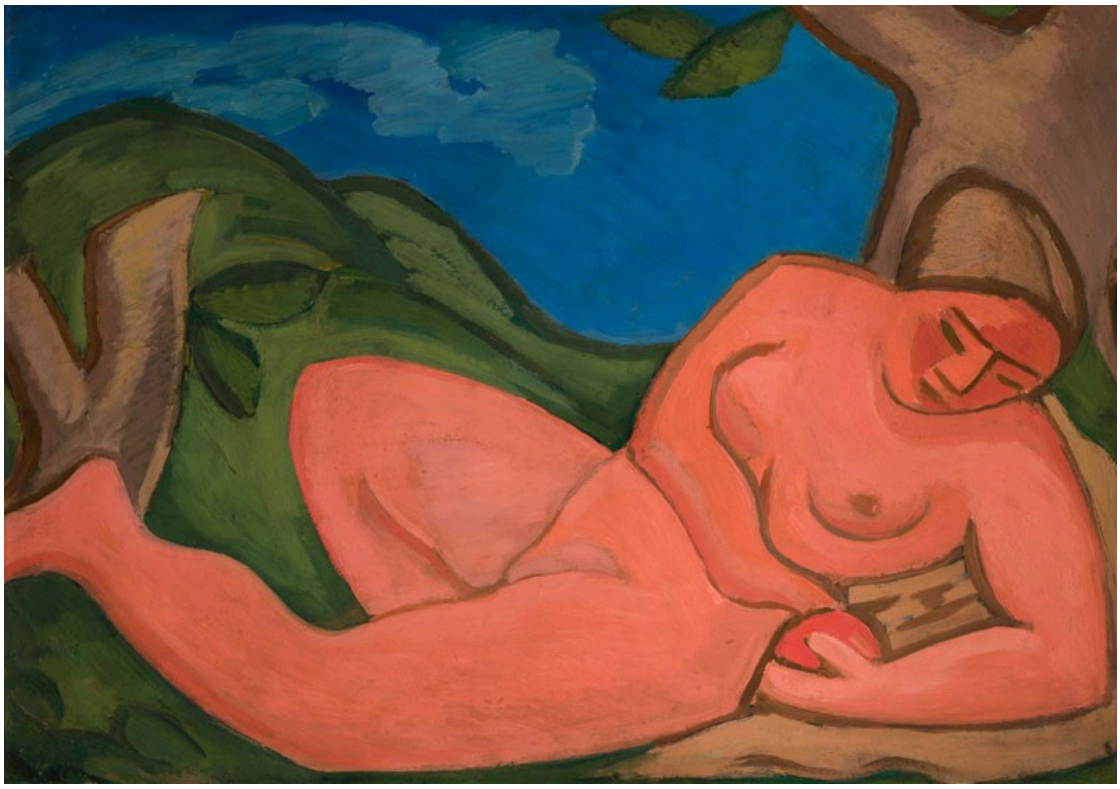
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 8598

08 / 20

Eve with an Apple

Václav Špála

1911–1912 · National Gallery Prague



Václav Špála. Eve with an Apple. Image credit: Václav Špála; Source credit: https://sbirky.ngprague.cz/en/dielo/CZE:NG.O_7979. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The large red-pink body is held by dark outlines against green slopes and blue sky. Its scale gives Eve a presence comparable to the terrain around her. The broad areas of colour join figure and landscape on the painted surface, while their distinct boundaries keep the subject readable.

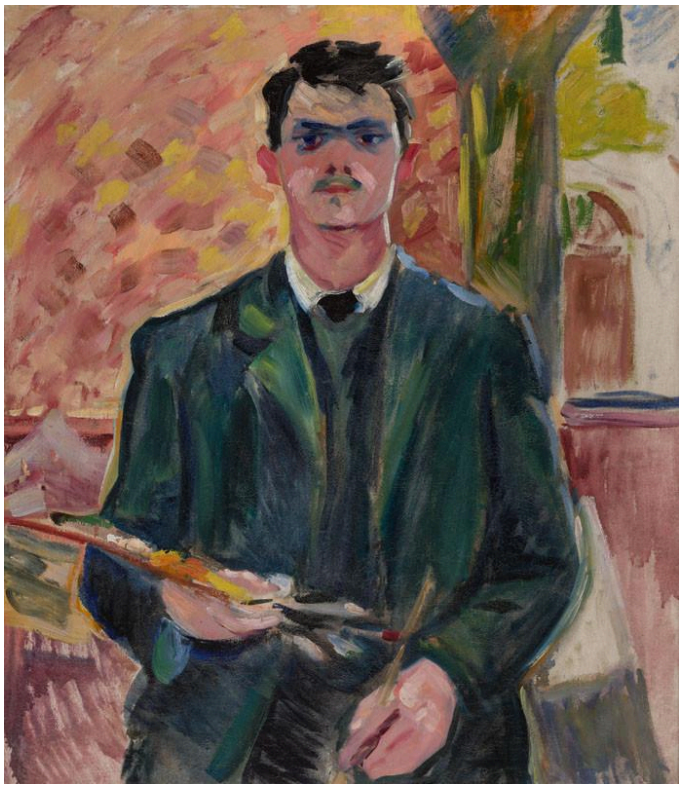
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 7979

09 / 20

Self-Portrait

Václav Špála

1908 · National Gallery Prague



Václav Špála. Self-Portrait. Image credit: Václav Špála; Source credit: https://sbirky.ngprague.cz/en/dielo/CZE:NG.O_3482. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The palette announces the sitter's occupation; the blue and green divisions across his face demonstrate what that occupation can involve. Likeness does not require every patch to imitate a conventional skin tone. In this self-portrait, the painter's identity is carried by the handling of colour as well as by the tools shown across his lap.

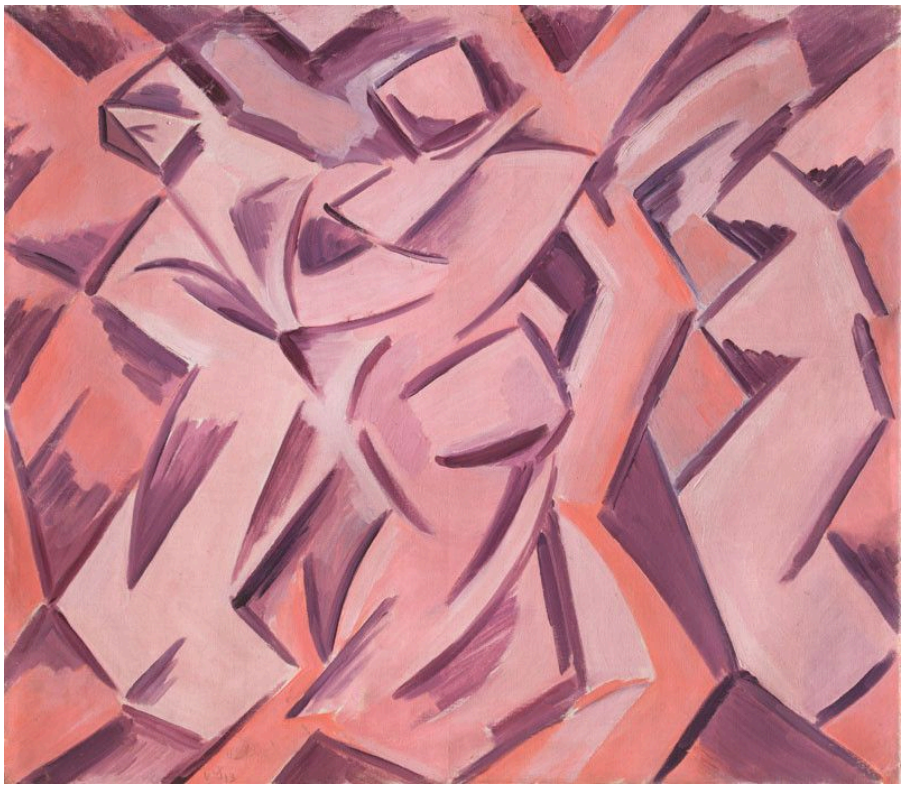
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 3482

10 / 20

Three Washerwomen

Václav Špála

1913 · National Gallery Prague



Václav Špála. Three Washerwomen. Image credit: Václav Špála; Source credit: https://sbirky.ngprague.cz/en/dielo/CZE:NG.O_9019. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The washerwomen are difficult to separate because bent backs and arms fit into a shared pattern of angles. Their repeated labour supplies the basis for that pattern. The picture reduces the surrounding setting, leaving the act of washing recognisable through the positions it requires rather than through an inventory of domestic objects.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 9019

11 / 20

At an Exhibition in Paris

Karel Špillar

1906 · National Gallery Prague



Karel Špillar. At an Exhibition in Paris. Image credit: Karel Špillar; National Gallery Prague. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Karel_%C5%A0pillar_-_At_an_Exhibition_in_Paris_-_O_6492_-_National_Gallery_Prague.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

An exhibition normally directs attention toward its artworks. Špillar directs it instead toward the people walking, standing and looking among them. The foreground figure establishes a near position within this social space, while pictures and display stands become its setting. Visiting art is itself made into an activity worth depicting.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 6492

12 / 20

In a Café

Karel Špillar

1904 · National Gallery Prague



Karel Špillar. In a Café. Image credit: Karel Špillar; National Gallery Prague. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Karel_%C5%A0pillar_-_In_a_Caf%C3%A9_-_O_5283_-_National_Gallery_Prague.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

Hats, flowers and cups give the café a social character even where faces remain partly withheld. Light clothing loosens into the warmer surrounding marks, making the people less separate from the room. The picture offers shared occupation of a public place without supplying a definite conversation for the figures at its table.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 5283

13 / 20

Children Receiving Breakfast

Ferdinand Georg Waldmüller

1859 · National Gallery Prague



Ferdinand Georg Waldmüller. Children received their breakfast. Image credit: Ferdinand Georg Waldmüller; Source credit: repro from artbook. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The doorway divides the bright exterior from the dark room, placing the children at different points of visibility. Food passes among them while the boy by the outer wall stands more clearly apart. A shared breakfast contains distinct positions of waiting and receiving; the group need not be treated as one uniform expression of childhood.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 12502

14 / 20

Count and Countess von Hartig as Roman Charity

Barbara Krafft

1797 · National Gallery Prague



Barbara Krafft. Count Franz de Paula Graf von Hartig and his wife Eleanore as Caritas Romana. Image credit: Barbara Krafft; Source credit: kultura.zpravy.idnes.cz. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Named sitters take on the subject of Roman Charity, so the picture asks to be understood as both a double portrait and a borrowed story. Their close bodily arrangement would be unusual in a straightforward social likeness. The historical role affects how they are presented without making the painted incident an event from their own lives.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 9690

15 / 20

Diogenes

Maximilian Pirner

1893 · National Gallery Prague



Maximilian Pirner. Diogenes. Image credit: Maximilian Pirner; National Gallery Prague. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Max_Pirner_-_Diogenes_-_O_5069_-_National_Gallery_Prague.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The elderly philosopher bends near his barrel while airborne figures occupy a different register above. Rough ground and simple shelter give the lower figure a tangible place, against which the upper fantasy can be measured. The picture's two zones remain connected through their contrast in bodily need, position and apparent freedom of movement.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 5069

16 / 20

Evening Silence

Antonín Hudeček

1900 · National Gallery Prague



Antonín Hudeček. Evening Silence. Image credit: Antonín Hudeček; National Gallery Prague. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Anton%C3%ADn_Hude%C4%8Dek_-_Evening_Silence_-_O_8411_-_National_Gallery_Prague.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The woman faces the valley, leaving her expression unavailable. Her position gives the landscape someone within it who also looks outward, while the curved path keeps the foreground connected to distance. The dusk can hold attention without a narrated event. Stillness is established through the arrangement, not through a claim about what she feels.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 8411

17 / 20

Self-Portrait with Her Father

Pepa Mařáková

1896 · National Gallery Prague



Pepa Mařáková. Self-Portrait with Her Father. Image credit: Pepa Mařáková; National Gallery Prague. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Pepa_Ma%C5%99%C3%A1kov%C3%A1_-_Self-Portrait_with_Her_Father_-_O_3591_-_National_Gallery_Prague.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

Mařáková faces outward while her father turns toward her, allowing the two directions of attention to remain unequal. Their painting equipment makes this a shared professional setting as well as a family portrait. Her father taught her and enabled informal access to the Prague Academy at a time when women could not enroll: the relationship had practical consequences beyond this room.

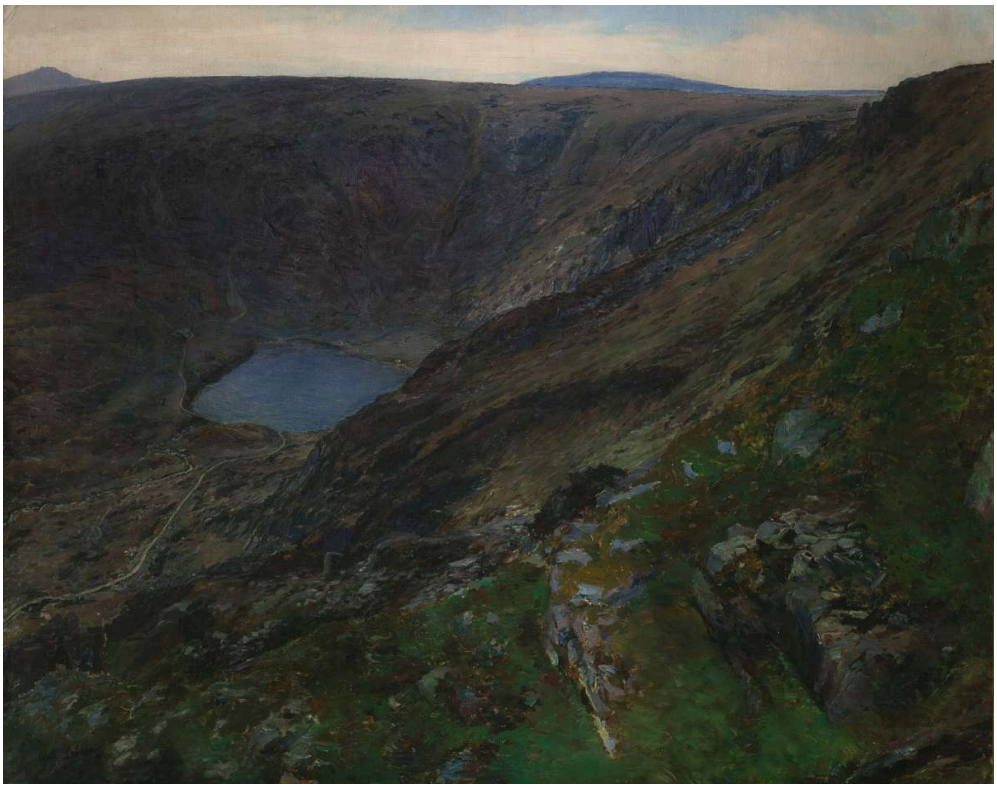
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 3591

18 / 20

Mountain Lake in the Giant Mountains

Otakar Lebeda

1896 · National Gallery Prague



Otakar Lebeda. Mountain Lake in the Giant Mountains. Image credit: Otakar Lebeda; Source credit: National Gallery in Prague. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The lake lies low within steep surrounding slopes, giving the mountains an enclosing structure. Broken foreground rocks establish a nearer, rougher scale before the eye reaches the water. Rather than opening into an unlimited panorama, the landscape measures distance through the terrain that contains it.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 3765

19 / 20

Moravian Slovak Madonna: Moravian Song

Jože Uprka

1902 · National Gallery Prague



Jože Uprka. Moravian Slovak Madonna (Moravian Song). Image credit: Jože Uprka; National Gallery Prague. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Jo%C5%BEa_Uprka_-_Moravian_Slovak_Madonna_(Moravian_Song)_-_O_3919_-_National_Gallery_Prague.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The central devotional figure and the people in regional dress operate at different scales of attention. Three panels provide room for a shared religious focus and many participants in communal ceremony. Clothing and repeated gestures give the gathering local specificity, keeping the triptych from functioning as an interchangeable image of worship.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 3919

20 / 20

Sunday on the Periphery

Georges Kars

1920 · National Gallery Prague



Georges Kars. Sunday on the Periphery. Image credit: Georges Kars; National Gallery Prague. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Ji%C5%99%C3%AD_Kars_-_Sunday_on_the_Periphery_-_O_12797_-_National_Gallery_Prague.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

Resting figures and people in motion share the angular forms of the trees and ground. The public landscape is compressed rather than divided neatly into isolated bodies and a distant backdrop. Sunday leisure is thus presented through a common pictorial structure, even though the people within it remain occupied in different ways.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 12797

Compare roles, then dates

Place Rousseau, Mařáková and Špála together in Artline to compare how each pictures the work of being an artist. Their dates provide context, not proof of a direct relationship. The National Gallery uses several buildings and changing displays; check the relevant collection and work before choosing a visiting route.

Further reading

Concerning the Spiritual in Art

Wassily Kandinsky; translated by Michael Sadleir · Read free · English

Kandinsky's writing supplies one contemporary argument for colour becoming independent of literal description. Compare it with Špála's pink landscapes and angular bodies without assuming that the paintings illustrate the book's ideas.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12

Artline · National Gallery Prague: Masterpieces